WORKING PRODUCTS 2026

Nothing crashed. It was just quietly wrong.

How organized challenge makes AI more reliable



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ORGANIZED CHALLENGE

A built-in devil's advocate

01 **Standard**

A readable specification describes what the agent should do.

02 **Challenge**

A second model looks for weaknesses. Simulations test difficult cases.

03 **Learning loop**

Confirmed failures become permanent tests. The next review becomes sharper.

THE CRITIC'S QUESTION

What evidence would disprove this answer?

The challenge must also stand up to review.

The evaluator argues. People decide.

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PROMPT REPOSITORY

What we version together

Component	Where it lives	Why we need it
Agent and contract	examples/ and DATA_POLICY.md	Task, outputs, and boundaries
Builder workflow	toolkit/skills/	Intake, draft, refine, simplify, validate, eval
Cases and graders	cases.json and adapter.mjs	Expectations, reasons, and checks
Execution and comparison	evaluation/	Profiles, runner, replay, and results
Experience and decisions	learning-cycle.md and run reports	Evidence, lesson, and version decision

Two levels: the task agent does the work. The builder improves and tests how it works.

How we develop a change

01	**Understand**	Read sources, clarify business questions, and check dependencies.
02	**Specify**	Record the task, boundaries, and output as a readable contract.
03	**Draft**	Create candidates. Define tools and failure paths explicitly.
04	**Simplify**	Remove duplication. Load context deliberately. Preserve safeguards.
05	**Test**	Inspect the text, run behavior, and compare independently.
06	**Decide**	Review evidence, test dependencies, and approve a version.

Saving tokens means removing unnecessary context while preserving behavior.

Workshop mode: offline replay by default. Live model calls require an explicit endpoint and budget.

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TEST DATA AND CHALLENGE

Real cases, variants, and simulated conversations

SANITIZED TRACES

What actually happened?

Prepare selected runs with only the evidence needed to reproduce the behavior.

CONSTRUCTED CASES

Where is coverage missing?

Vary boundaries, missing information, and known failures deliberately. Each case explains one expectation.

RESPONSIVE SIMULATIONS

How does the agent react?

A counterpart responds step by step. Tool failures and permitted actions need controlled test conditions.

RED TEAMING

Target assumptions, context, and permissions.
Confirmed weaknesses become permanent regression tests.

Keep development cases separate from independent evaluation.

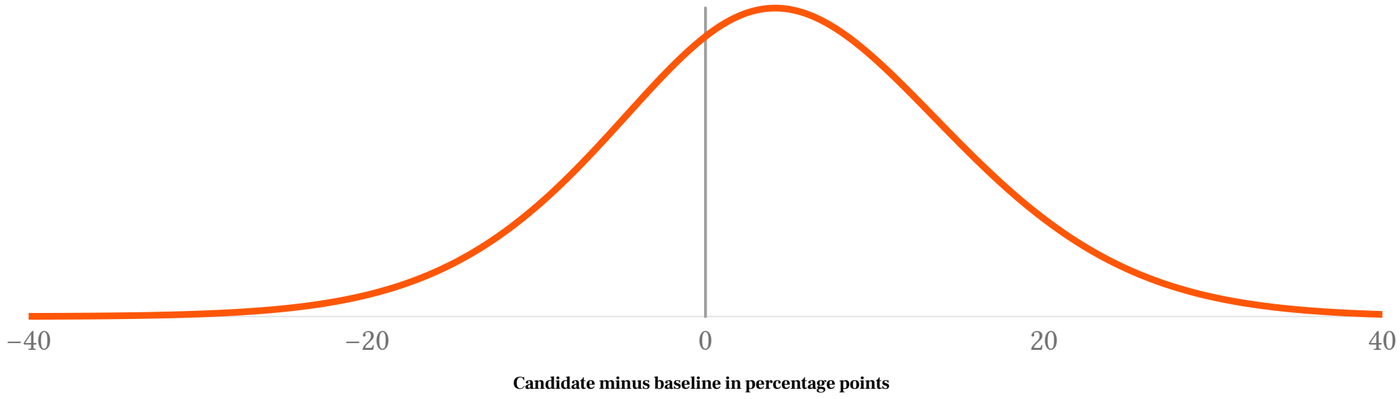
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EVALUATION AND UNCERTAINTY

Who judges, and how certain is the difference?

People resolve meaning. Code checks fixed rules.
Specialized evaluators justify judgments with evidence.

Teaching example: 17 of 20 correct versus 18 of 20.



67%

Probability of an advantage under the model assumptions

95% interval: −16.8 to +26.1 percentage points

Illustration: one scenario, binary scores, Beta(1,1) priors. Agreement is not correctness. Protected rules stay separate.

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DEBUGGING AND OPERATIONS

Make the error visible in the workflow

A TRACE CONNECTS	THE DEBUGGING QUESTION
Input and prepared context	Was the information missing before the model ran?
Prompt, model, and configuration	Which exact version acted?
Tool calls and responses	Did the error come from a tool?
Output, grade, and evidence	Is the answer wrong, or is the grader?
Correction and business outcome	What was actually stored or changed?

Synthetic replay: 24 of 24 candidate outputs fit the contract. 21 of 24 meet the full expected behavior.

Offline fixture replay, not live model performance. Traces show observable steps, not hidden reasoning.

How reviewed experience changes the next version

Generator	Handles the case with the current instructions.
Reflector	Proposes a narrow lesson from the result and evidence.
Curator	Adds a small, traceable context change.
Manager	**People review the lesson. Held-out cases test its effect.**

An answer needs challenge. An action needs accountability.

Thank you.

Questions?

TO TAKE WITH YOU

Who challenges plausible answers in your work?

Valentina Ibba